

File Analysis

The uploaded document contains several **intentional decoys** and one important clue.

1. Fake / Legacy Credentials

The document lists:

- Recovery2024!
- Recovery2024@Ops
- R3cov3ry_2024!

It explicitly states that these are **legacy credentials** that expire after 90 days, suggesting they are meant to mislead investigators.

2. Password Construction Rule

The document states:

[Project Codename] + [Symbol] + [4-digit year of operation]

It also says:

“The original passphrase predates the 2024 rotation cycle.”

Therefore, the correct password is likely built from:

- Project Codename
- A symbol
- A year **before 2024**

3. Hidden Metadata Clues

The DOCX metadata contains:

Field	Value
Author	GhostCell_Ops
Title	Project Nightfall Recovery
Comments	Archived under NF-series

These metadata values are not visible in the document body and are likely the real clues.

4. Most Likely Project Codename

From the metadata:

Project Codename = Nightfall

The comments field (NF-series) reinforces this.

5. Candidate Passwords

Using the naming convention:

- Nightfall!2023
- Nightfall@2023
- Nightfall#2023
- Nightfall\$2023
- Nightfall!2022
- Nightfall@2022
- NF!2023
- NF@2023

Conclusion

The document strongly suggests that the password is derived from **Nightfall + Symbol + Year**,

with the year being **before 2024**. The highest-probability candidates are:

1. **Nightfall!2023**
2. **Nightfall@2023**
3. **Nightfall#2023**

The next step would be to test these candidate passwords against the encrypted file associated with the challenge. 😊